

# SF Enterprise Hackathon Problem Statement

**Date:** August 14, 2026 **Venue:** San Francisco **Format:** One-day build sprint **Eligibility:** Open to all participants individually or in teams of up to 4

**Platforms:** SoftwareForge.ai (Forge) + Daytona

## 1. Theme

Enterprises run on software that's often slow to build, harder to maintain, and even harder to modernize. This hackathon is about showing what's possible when you build with **Forge** and run/test on **Daytona** going from idea to working, deployed prototype in a single day, using AI-assisted development and secure, disposable dev environments to move at a pace that wasn't possible before.

Every team will build their project using **Forge** as the core AI development platform, and **Daytona** as the environment/execution layer their project is built, tested, and run in. The goal is simple: pick a real enterprise problem, and use Forge + Daytona together to design, build, run, and ship a working prototype that solves it.

## 2. Platform Focus

### 2a. SoftwareForge.ai (Forge)

Forge is an AI-powered software development platform designed to streamline full-stack software delivery. Instead of writing every line by hand, teams describe what they want to build and leverage Forge to generate, iterate, and refine working code frontend, backend, and integrations significantly faster than standard workflows.

**Get Access:** <https://hackathon.softwareforge.ai/>

**How to use it:**

- **Rapid Generation:** Use Forge's AI engines to quickly scaffold components, APIs, and business logic.
- **Iterative Refinement:** Prompt, tweak, and iterate on generated code to fit complex enterprise requirements.
- **Full-Stack Execution:** Ensure both frontend interface and backend service logic are running through the platform.

### 2b. Daytona

Daytona is a secure, elastic infrastructure layer for running code including AI-generated code in isolated, disposable sandboxes that spin up in milliseconds. Where Forge is where you generate and iterate on your application, Daytona is where you run, test, and validate it in a clean, standardized, reproducible environment, without wrestling with local setup, dependency drift, or "works on my machine" issues.

**Get Started:** <https://www.daytona.io/>

**How to use it suggested use cases for this hackathon:**

- **Instant, Standardized Environments:** Spin up a fresh Daytona sandbox for your team instead of manually configuring laptops everyone works in an identical, pre-configured environment, cutting environment-setup friction to near zero on a time-boxed sprint day.
- **Safe Execution of AI-Generated Code:** Run and test code scaffolded/generated by Forge inside an isolated Daytona sandbox rather than directly on your host machine useful when iterating fast and you don't fully trust every AI-generated change yet.
- **Parallel Experimentation:** Spin up multiple sandboxes in parallel to try different architectural approaches or integrations side-by-side, and simply discard the ones that don't work no cleanup overhead.
- **Reproducible Demos:** Use a Daytona snapshot of your working environment as your live demo environment, so what you show judges is guaranteed to match what you built no last-minute "it worked earlier" surprises.
- **Backend/Integration Testing Sandbox:** Stand up a disposable sandbox to test enterprise integrations (APIs, webhooks, data connectors) generated in Forge without risking a shared or production-like environment.
- **Agent/Automation Workflows:** If your project includes an AI agent that writes, executes, or tests its own code (e.g., a workflow-automation or internal-tools agent), use Daytona sandboxes as the secure runtime the agent operates in a natural fit for the Workflow Automation and Internal Tools tracks.

**Note on Judging:** Teams are expected to build their entire submission using Forge for development **and** Daytona for running/testing/deploying it not just prototype an idea or write documentation. Judges will specifically look for real, meaningful usage of **both** platforms throughout the build.

### 3. Track Focus & Project Directions

Pick any high-friction enterprise problem. Teams can choose from, remix, or bring their own concept across these suggested tracks:

| Track / Direction           | Description                                                                                                         | Target Impact                                         |
|-----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| Internal Tools & Dashboards | Custom administrative portals, live operational dashboards, or triage tools that remove daily workflow bottlenecks. | Saves operational time and increases data visibility. |

|                                  |                                                                                                        |                                                       |
|----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Legacy Modernization</b>      | Re-architected and modernized versions of outdated, clunky, or monolithic internal systems.            | Reduces technical debt and improves user experience.  |
| <b>Workflow Automation</b>       | End-to-end automated solutions replacing repetitive, manual cross-department tasks or data entry.      | Minimizes human error and speeds up execution loops.  |
| <b>Departmental Productivity</b> | Specialized collaboration tools optimized for specific team functions (e.g., HR, Legal, Ops, Finance). | Removes functional silos and speeds up team handoffs. |

## 4. Reference Architecture

Below is the standard pipeline winning projects will follow, using Forge and Daytona together:

**Data Flow:** Describe system requirements to Forge → Iterate frontend and backend code on-platform → Spin up a Daytona sandbox to run and test the generated build → Connect enterprise integrations and validate them inside the sandbox → Deploy the functional end-to-end prototype to users, using the Daytona environment as the reproducible base for the live demo.

## 5. Judging Criteria

| Category                            | Weight | Focus                                                                                                                     |
|-------------------------------------|--------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Working Prototype</b>            | 40%    | Does the application run end-to-end and actually solve the target problem?                                                |
| <b>Built on Forge &amp; Daytona</b> | 30%    | Real, substantial use of Forge for development and Daytona for running/testing throughout the build not a one-off import. |
| <b>Impact</b>                       | 20%    | How much friction, time, or cost this would realistically save in an enterprise setting.                                  |
| <b>Presentation</b>                 | 10%    | Clarity of the live demo and how well the problem and solution are communicated.                                          |

## 6. Submission Requirements

- **Working Prototype Link:** Hosted URL built on Forge and run/verified in a Daytona sandbox.
- **Demo:** Short live demonstration or 2–3 minute video walkthrough (ideally shown running from your Daytona environment).
- **Team Details:** Team name and individual member info.

- **Problem Overview:** A brief explanation of the problem selected and its enterprise value.

## 7. Setup Checklist

Have these steps completed before the event starts sprint time moves fast!

- [ ] Create a Forge account and confirm platform access. <https://hackathon.softwareforge.ai/>
- [ ] Create a Daytona account and confirm you can spin up a sandbox: <https://www.daytona.io/>
- [ ] Form your team (up to 4 people) or register as an individual participant.
- [ ] Brainstorm target enterprise pain points so your team can begin building immediately.
- [ ] Use Daytona to set up your project's development/execution environment before you start building in Forge, so your first generated build has somewhere to run.

Questions regarding Forge or Daytona during the event should be directed to the on-site mentor table.